

Student Evaluation of Teaching, Summer II 2025
Allen Wilson, POLI 209-001 ANALYZING PUBLIC OPINION
Mode: IP (In Person)

Raters	Students
Responded	12
Invited	12
Response Ratio	100%

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. Overall, I learned a great deal from this course.	4.75	5.00	0.45	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	25.0%	75.0%
2. The instructor treated all students with respect.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
3. The instructor encouraged students to participate in this class.	4.83	5.00	0.39	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	16.7%	83.3%
4. The instructor saw cultural and personal differences as assets.	4.50	5.00	1.00	12	0.0%	8.3%	8.3%	8.3%	75.0%
5. I could really be myself in this course.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
6. In this course I had multiple opportunities to express my viewpoints and questions.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
7. The course challenged me to think deeply about the subject matter.	4.58	5.00	0.67	12	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	25.0%	66.7%
8. The design of this course (e.g., its format, selected materials, assignments, exercises, quizzes, etc.) helped me better understand the subject matter.	4.75	5.00	0.45	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	25.0%	75.0%
9. Overall, this course was excellent.	4.83	5.00	0.39	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	16.7%	83.3%

11. The instructor held class meetings consistent with the official schedule published for this course.		
N	Yes	No
12	100.0%	0.0%

Department Specific

Political Science Undergraduate: Instructor Ratings

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. Demonstrates enthusiasm about teaching.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
2. Communicates clearly and logically.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
3. Promotes a climate of mutual respect.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
4. Encourages student questions.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
5. Emphasizes critical thinking.	4.75	5.00	0.45	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	25.0%	75.0%
6. Uses teaching strategies that promote active involvement.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
7. Clearly communicates expectations for student performance.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
8. Regularly provides constructive criticism of student performance.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
9. Provides timely feedback on student performance.	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%
10. Provides a fair evaluation of student performance.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
11. Is available when needed.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
12. Is well-prepared for instruction.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
13. Overall, considering both the possibilities and limitations of the subject matter and course, I would rate this instructor as "excellent."	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%

Political Science Undergraduate: Course Quality Ratings

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
14. Course goals and objectives are clearly specified.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
15. Requirements (e.g., assignments, attendance, student responsibilities) are clearly specified.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
16. Course assignments are clearly related to the course objectives.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
17. Instructional methods in the course facilitate my learning.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
18. In general, the course is well-organized.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
19. Course materials stimulated critical thinking.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
20. I know significantly more about this subject than before I took this course.	5.00	5.00	0.00	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
21. Overall, considering its content, design, and structure, I would rate this course as "excellent."	4.92	5.00	0.29	12	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	91.7%

Open-Ended Responses

1. In what ways did your instructor make learning possible for you during the Summer II 2025 semester?

Comments
Professor Allen was very understanding of everyone's situations and worked with students to ensure a positive learning environment, accommodating their needs.
He made sure to keep an objective lens, while also addressing topics the way they are. All the material was readily available to us, and we could ask for help if and when we needed it. Allen also brought a fun, learning environment and always found a way to keep things interesting!
He structured the class around a large, group-based survey that we were able use knowledge from the lectures for to enhance the project as we developed it. It almost created a narrative-type structure throughout the class that helped really nail the concepts he was teaching and their application. Additionally, he was extremely responsive to our questions and very personable.
Very helpful and friendly
Mr. Wilson was very accommodating to peoples' situations and allowed people to still strive for academic success.
Allen facilitated a learning environment that was rigorously paced, but also encouraging of different learning modalities. From lecture, to small-group discussion, to guest speakers, the variety of content kept things engaging, even when concepts increased in difficulty. Many of us had work and other outside obligations, yet Mr. Wilson was accommodating. When challenging political topics would come up, he encouraged us to be respectful of one another's lived experiences.
He gave us a lot of work to do within a short session, but was often available for feedback on assignments and was flexible with his deadlines. Lectures were engaging as well.
He explained everything in a very humanistic way that was applicable to our work and our lives. He was very engaging and made me want to come to class.
Professor Held office hours before and after class.
He engaged with our questions and provided us with materials that helped us learn. The assignments provided clear steps to learn how to code.
He was very engaged with all the students and hosted frequent office hours.

2. Which aspects of this course should be kept for future times this course is taught?

Comments
The overall structure of the course and the flexibility of the later lectures should be kept. Also definitely let Allen teach this again; this is his jam
all
Keeping the group work has been very educational and helpful especially for those who struggle with coding themselves. I found it to be very productive.
The in-class R-Lab assignments were really helpful, especially for those who did not have much coding experience. I also really appreciated the grace and flexibility we were given in this course, as there were may new elements we were exposed to.
The accessibility of course material (lecture slides, HTML Labs, Files, etc.) were very helpful and allowed us to backtrack when needed.
Most importantly, the allotted TIME TO WORK IN CLASS was extremely helpful, especially when it came to group-project work. It was a wonderful way to trouble-shoot and connect with our peers, while cutting down on the amount of time we were to spend on assignments outside of class.
Final project. The quizzes are nice benchmarks.
The group project should definitely be kept for the future. Being able to create your own survey and run it while collecting data, helped us learn how to use the information we gather.
– Socialization and Partisanship
Everything
Allen.
A one-day grace period for all assignments.
Everything!



Department Specific

Please comment on the strengths of the course.

Comments
– Interesting – Relevant – Uses both qualitative reasoning skills and quantitative reasoning skills
The course was fast-paced but didn't feel like it; everything was able to be covered in depth and in a way that was extremely engaging. The subject matter was very interesting, and it was also very flexible.
very fun
The coding instruction was straightforward and relevant for the assignments.
The course blended qualitative data collection and political science in a way that was engaging, stimulating, and rewarding. Because it was a smaller class, we were able to utilize one-on-one time that would otherwise be limited in bigger classes (i.e. during fall and spring). Mr. Wilson came prepared EVERY day—for example, the last week of class was our special topics week. He fielded a survey to assess our interest, and, although many of us responded rather last-minute to the survey, Mr. Wilson created well-polished slide deck.
The course does its job . We have all worked hard to build hard skills, such as creating and fielding surveys, analyzing and interpreting data, and discussing findings.
Engaging lectures. Challenging but not impossible coding assignments. Fun final project.
applicable readings, appropriate amount of work, clear understandings of conclusions, classes go by quickly because they're interesting
Organization of syllabus and projects
Learning how to code in a structured way

Please comment on the limitations of the course.

Comments
– Occurs during a shorter semester (Summer)
The pace of the course is probably the only limitation, but it didn't feel fast during it.
n/a
The timely nature of a summer session course can just make some weeks dense with assignments due.
The final deliverable for the course is a research project involving survey or data collection and analysis using R. I don't believe it would have been feasible to complete this individually, as the workload is a bit demanding. I do think it would have made more sense for an individual project if the expectations for the components of collection (like how many correlation tests we are meant to discuss in the final paper, descriptives we are to describe, hypotheses to test) were clearly outlined. Balancing the project work alongside the assigned readings and R assignments would have been extremely difficult, individually.
This holds true especially for Qualtrics and its collaborative use. It is not the best for real-time editing for large groups using different computers.
I think if there were clearly defined expectations of group members (in terms of how they are meant to pull their weight IF they opt out of an individual project) it could alleviate some of the inevitable headache that does come with a group project.
I also think the special topics week could have taken the form of a day or two, with the rest of the week reserved for project work. There was disconnect in project responsibilities (and capabilities) among group members that prolonged the work on many fronts.
Just a lot of work for summer class. Wish there was more time to get more survey responses.
N/A
I dont have any as of right now.
To short to absorb all of the material in the truncated timeline of the summer.

Please comment on the strengths of the instructor.

Comments
This course was a lot of fun to take during the summer semester, and Allen made it that much better! He always accommodated us appropriately for the time that was needed to do assignments and built the schedule to be flexible. He is really knowledgeable about both R and political science/public opinion, and is enthusiastic to share what he knows. He also works fast to grade all assignments and give thorough feedback, which is incredibly appreciated. Allen cares about not just the subject, but also his students, which is evident in the way that he teaches this course. I could not have asked for a better professor to teach POLI 209!
Absolutely amazing professor; he was made to teach this subject. This is my return to classes after a semester off, and I haven't felt more engaged/connected to a professor probably ever in my time here at UNC.
Very knowledgeable about these topics and a great presenter
He is very patient and passionate about his job which is inspiring and creates a very nice academic environment.
Mr. Wilson is very thorough. He shows up and ensures that no one is left behind, often taking time out of his day to break down feedback after class and throughout office hours. He genuinely wants us to learn by any means. He is witty, lighthearted, and kind, which is very refreshing especially in political science. He is bright and his future is certain in teaching. Anyone would be lucky to be in his class!
His approach to the material is always interesting because he thinks in an unconventional way that encourages us students to examine issues from a lens different than our own. One thing I really enjoy about Mr. Wilson is how he borrows from different academic fields to enrich the concepts we learn in class. He goes above and beyond, providing us with supplemental material and space to digest complicated topics.
Respectful to others. Enthusiastic about and prepared on course material. Flexible schedule.
Engaging and likable professor, very funny, makes me want to take another class with him, clearly very knowledgeable and excited about the topic!
– Professional – Organized – Caring Instructor – Serious about teaching about course material
Funny, Smart instructive.

Please comment on the limitations of the instructor.

Comments
N/A
His only limitation is that the university isn't letting him teach this again in the fall—a shame.
n/a
None, my personal limitations was me being a commuting student so I could not go to office hours in person but, if I would have asked he would have made himself available.
I think he can be a bit harsh with his feedback, which can be concerning (and therefore challenging to make adjustments/adapt) given the fast pace and meaty workload of the course. I do understand it is because he is passionate and well informed on class topics. Yet, because there's so much material in such a short time, there can sometimes be a disconnect between the feedback he gives and the realities of keeping up.
He needs to sleep and hydrate more!
N/A
N/A
I dont have nay as of right now.
none